“Where is she?”

“I ordered her to be placed in the camp at Jargeau.”

Rose drew back, confused. She’d heard that name before . . . It took a moment before she could figure out where—Léa had told her that Maître Mallon had gone to camps in Pithiviers to help Jewish families who were sent there from Paris. Jargeau wasn’t far from there. Rose felt the breath go out of her and tears welling, but seeing Paulette standing at the threshold, she knew that crying would only frighten the child and wouldn’t help Léa. As soon as the sun came up, she’d see Maître Mallon and ask for his advice. Maybe they could go together to Jargeau. “Can I visit her?”

“Yes.” His eyes narrowed on Rose, making her turn away.

Virginie put her arms around Rose. “It’ll be all right. We’ll get them both back.”

“I’m afraid you’re wrong, Madame LeBlanc,” the Weinführer said. “I’ve come to inform you that due to your husband’s criminal behavior—not limited to black market smuggling but also stocking weapons for the Resistance—”

“I don’t know who told you that, but my husband isn’t involved with the Resistance.” She squeezed Rose’s hand.

“A very good source told us. He was condemned to death by a German Military Tribunal.” He checked his watch. “And executed an hour ago.”

Virginie drew in a sharp breath, her body shuddered as she buckled to her knees and a deep, desperate moan escaped her lips. She buried her face in her hands and sobbed uncontrollably.

Rose’s limbs trembled as she rushed to console her. “Oh, Virginie,” she said, tears in her eyes, throat raw. “I’m so, so sorry.”

“Maman, what’s happening?” Paulette called out. “Why are you crying?”

Rose’s heart twisted at the alarm in Paulette’s voice. She felt the weight of the poor girl’s grief pressing down, knowing her world had shifted forever, just as it had for her and Léa after losing their parents. She knelt beside Paulette, wrapping her arms around her tightly, whispering, “Your Papa has gone away. I promise, we will get through this together and everything will be all right.”

But deep in her heart, she felt the raw truth: nothing would ever be the same again.